

Usability Report

Identifying Usability Gaps on mabeproducts.com

The logo for MABÊ is displayed within a light beige rectangular box with a thin black border. The text 'MABÊ' is rendered in a large, dark brown, serif typeface. The letter 'E' features a horizontal bar with a small opening in the center, and a small horizontal line is positioned above the letter 'B'.

MABÊ

Dheepthi Sundaresan and Esha Perisetla

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Dr. Lynne Cooke

Introduction

The purpose of this usability test is to evaluate the user experience of mabeproducts.com, which is an e-commerce platform that sells luxury baby carriers. When it comes to shopping for baby carriers, parents often put in careful thought and consideration involving decisions regarding safety, comfort, usability, cost, etc. It is essential that this website clearly communicates all of that information and supports efficient navigation as well as clarity.

This study focuses on understanding how users interact with the website when completing common tasks such as browsing and analyzing products, evaluating features, and making purchase decisions with a baby in mind. By observing user behaviors and gathering feedback, this study aims to identify usability issues, areas of confusion, and opportunities for improvement within the website's content, structure, and overall design.

The findings from this study will be used to provide actionable recommendations to enhance the user experience, improve clarity as well as accessibility, and support efficient and confident decision-making for potential customers.

Website Overview

The mabeproducts.com website is an e-commerce platform designed to sell and promote their luxury baby carriers. The site showcases a minimalistic aesthetic with hues of beige and pastels as well as high-quality images depicting active and happy lifestyles to promote the brand as both design-forward but also functional, as seen in figure 1. The primary goal of

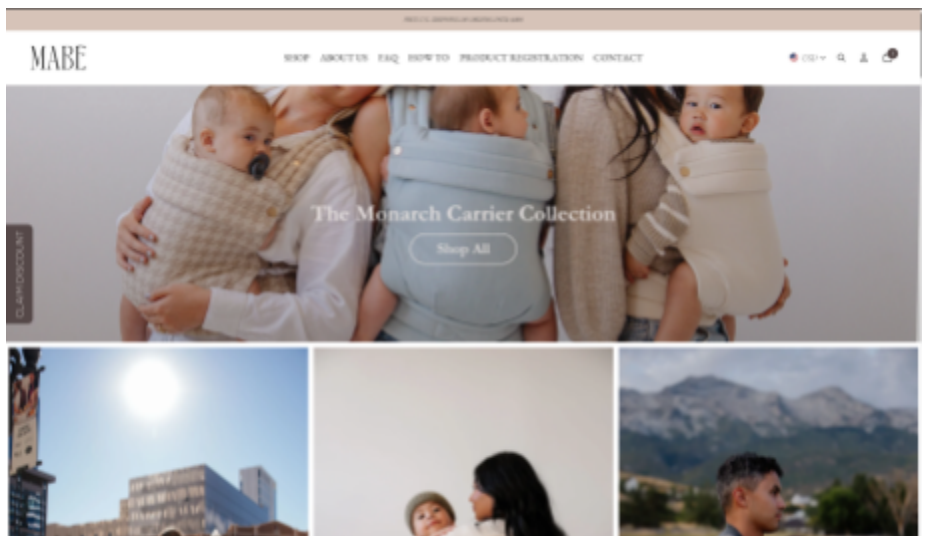


Figure 1: Screenshot of Mabe's Homepage

the website is to guide customers towards purchasing the baby carriers while informing them about product features and benefits.

The homepage introduces users to the brand through featured products, empowering messaging, and call-to-action buttons. Navigation is structured at the top with a menu which allows users to browse through different product categories, learn additional information about the brand, and access additional resources. Individual product pages show descriptions, images, and highlighted features that support the user's decision-making process.

This website was selected for usability testing because it reflects a high-consideration e-commerce experience, where users need to assess multiple factors when considering purchasing a baby carrier. It relies on both visual presentation as well as detailed product information to ease the user's decision making process, which is why this is an effective platform for evaluating usability strengths and areas for improvement.

Test Method

The usability test used a moderated think-aloud method, where participants were asked to say what they were thinking, what they expected to happen, and when they felt confused while using the website.

The testing was conducted using a mixed-method approach:

In-person testing: We conducted the session in person using a laptop. The participant interacted with the website while we observed their actions and noted behaviors, errors, and comments.

Remote testing: We conducted sessions through Zoom with screen sharing enabled. We observed participants' interactions in real time and documented observations through note-taking.

- Each participant followed the same testing structure.
- Participants were first read a standardized orientation script.
- Completed a pre-test questionnaire.
- They then performed two task scenarios beginning from the Mabe homepage.
- After completing the tasks, participants filled out a post-test questionnaire and responded to follow-up questions.
- Each session lasted about 20 minutes.

Participants

	Participant 1	Participant 2	Participant 3	Participant 4
Name	Gauri Kadbane	Himaja Chilaka Marthy	Meenakshi Sundaresan	Jaya Kondapavuluri
Gender	Female	Female	Female	Male
Age Range	20-30	20-30	40-50	20-30
Parent/Expecting	No	Yes	Yes	No
Prior Online Purchase Experience	Yes, but did not end up purchasing	Yes, for themselves	Yes, but did not end up purchasing	Yes, but only as a gift
Baby Carrier Usage Frequency	Rarely	Occasionally	Never	Never
Key Decision Factor	Comfort, cost, style, safety	Comfort, fit, style, safety	Comfort, fit, style, cost, safety	Comfort, fit, style, cost, safety
Concerns When Shopping Online	Product quality, trust in brand, easy return/refund process, responsive customer service	Whether the carrier is safe for the child and if the product received will match what is shown online	If the fabric would be comfortable for me and the baby. I would also be concerned for safety.	My most important concern is the safety of the baby carrier and the cost of it. Most of the cheap carriers are not durable for a long period of time and are a waste of resources and time.
Budget range for buying a luxury baby carrier	\$100-\$150	\$150-\$200	\$100-\$150	\$50-\$100

Findings

Task 1: Shopping for a Baby Carrier

Preferred Path: [Homepage](#) > [Shop](#) > [\[Category\]](#) > [\[Specific Model\]](#) > [Product Details](#) > [Add To Cart](#)

	Participant 1	Participant 2	Participant 3	Participant 4
Task Success	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Time on Task	4 mins 25 secs	3 mins 10 secs	4 mins 50 secs	5 mins 50 secs
User Path	Homepage → Shop All → Product → Color Variations → Back Button → Product → Product Details → Add to Cart	Homepage → Shop All → Product → Color Variations → Shop → Product → Product Details → Customer Reviews → Add to Cart	Homepage → Shop → Monarch Buckle Carriers → Product → Product Details → Color Variations → Customer Reviews → Add to Cart	Homepage → Shop → Monarch Buckle Carriers → Product → Product Details → Customer Reviews → Product Details → Add to Cart
Error Count/ Observation	(01:10 min) The font is very small. (02:03 min) Began to scroll out of confusion because color options disappeared, clicked on the back button.	(00:45 min) The user wanted to zoom in further to view the detailing on the product. (02:20 min) Disappearance of color options for one product created confusion, requiring the user to click on Shop again and restart the process.	(02:30 min) The user found it difficult to read product details due to the small font and large text block. (3:45 min) The user was unable to clearly determine age and weight range for the product.	(01:30 min) The user had difficulty reading some of the text (03:50 min) The user stated that he was unable to determine what age range of babies that the product was meant for.

Task 2: Finding Instructions and Support

Preferred Path: [Homepage](#) > [How to](#) > [Monarch Toddler Sling](#) > [Threading a strap](#) > [Play video](#).

	Participant 1	Participant 2	Participant 3	Participant 4
Task Success	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Time on Task	35 sec	25 sec	50 sec	20 sec
User Path	Homepage → How to → Monarch Toddler Sling → Threading a strap → Played video	Homepage → How to → Monarch Toddler Sling → Threading a strap → Played video	Homepage → How to → Monarch Buckle Carrier → Start here → Played video	Homepage → How to → Monarch Toddler Sling → Threading a strap → Played video → FAQ → How to
Error Count/ Observation	No errors observed Navigation was intuitive and followed the expected path smoothly.	No errors observed Quickly navigated through the “How to” section and located the video.	No errors observed Smoothly navigated to the “How to” section and located the video.	No errors were observed, but the user got curious and went to the FAQ and noticed that the information there should be listed in the product details.

Key Trends Across Participants

- Users experienced confusion due to disappearing product color variations.
- Users relied on backtracking and restarting tasks, indicating weak navigation continuity.
- Visual clarity (small text) and lack of product detail visibility affected decision-making.
- Users were unable to find important information such as age and weight range.
- Task 2 showed no usability issues, suggesting that instructional navigation is effective.

Usability Issues and Recommendations

1. Visibility of Product Options (System Feedback Issue)

Upon selecting certain color variants, such as "Dream Wash Denim," the entire color selection menu completely disappears from the screen (refer to Figure 1 and Figure 2).

Evidence:

- Participant 1 (02:03 min) became confused when color options disappeared and used the back button
- Participant 2 (02:20 min) had to restart the process after encountering missing options

Impact:

This issue violates key usability principles such as visibility of system status and consistency, which state that users should always be able to see available actions and that similar elements should behave in predictable ways (Nielsen, 1994). When options disappear unexpectedly, users experience a breakdown in trust and must rely on memory instead of recognition, increasing cognitive load (Norman, 2013).

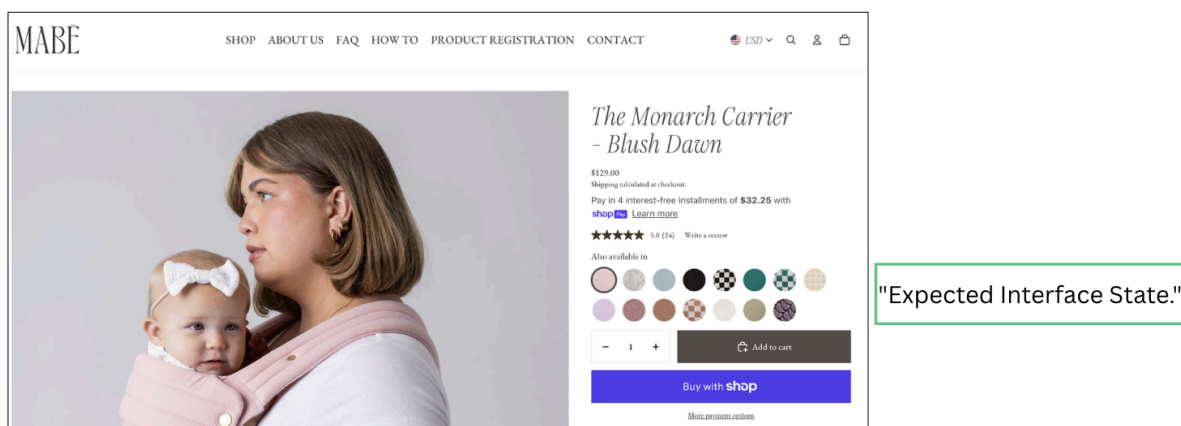


Figure 1: Standard product interface for the "Blush Dawn" carrier, which displays a clear color selection menu.

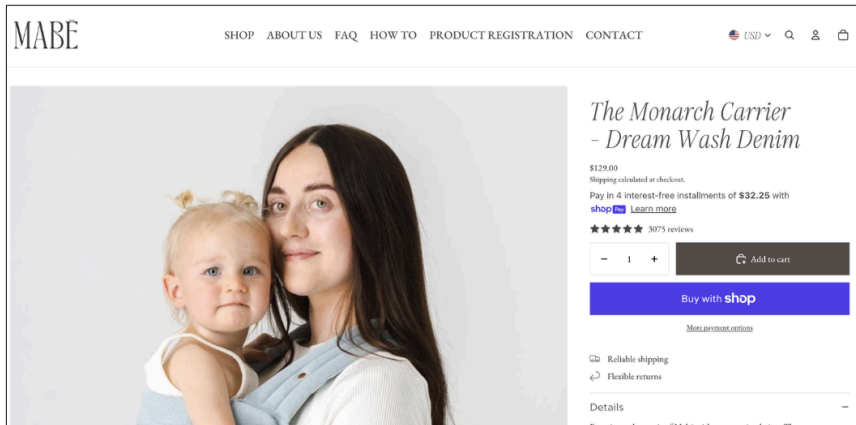


Figure 2: Interface after selecting "Dream Wash Denim" carrier, where the color selection menu has completely disappeared, creating a functional dead-end.

Recommendation: Keep the color menu in the same place on every single product page. If a color is out of stock, do not hide it. Instead, make the color circle look "greyed out" or add a "Sold Out" label. This way, the website always looks and acts the same, so the user never feels lost.

2. Readability and Visual Clarity (Visual Design Issue)

Users experienced difficulty reading product information due to small font sizes on the product page (refer to Figure 3).

Evidence:

- Participant 1 at (01:10 min) noted that the "font is very small," indicating strain in reading product details.
- Participant 3 at (2:30 min) found herself struggling to keep her attention span on details because of how small the font was for how much text was written. She stated that bullets could have been used.
- Participant 4 at (01:30 min) stated that the text is too small to read and zoomed in on his screen to read the product details better.

Impact:

Poor readability increases cognitive load and slows down information processing, especially in e-commerce contexts where users need to quickly evaluate product features before making decisions.

According to Krug (2014), users do not read web content word-for-word but instead scan for key information. When text is too small or dense, it disrupts this scanning behavior and increases cognitive load. Additionally, research shows that poor typography can significantly reduce comprehension and task efficiency (Lidwell, Holden, & Butler, 2010).

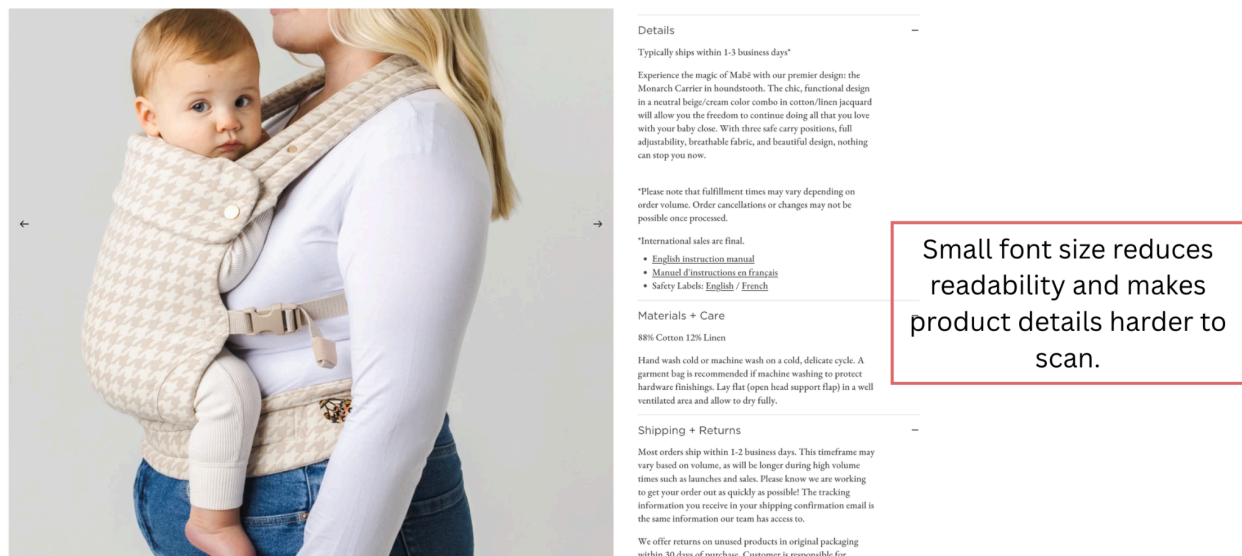


Figure 3: *Product details displaying small and dense text.*

Recommendation:

Increase font size and improve visual hierarchy through spacing, contrast, and typographic scaling. Clear readability supports faster scanning and aligns with usability guidelines for legibility and information accessibility.

3. Clarity of Product Information (Content / Information Design Issue)

Users experienced difficulty understanding key product information, particularly details related to age and weight range. The important information was not present on the product page where users expect it to be and was instead located in the FAQ section (see Figure 4 and Figure 5).

Evidence:

- Participant 3 at (03:45 min) was unable to clearly determine the age and weight range for the product.
- Participant 4 at (03:50 min) stated that they could not determine what age range of babies the product was meant for.

Impact:

When essential product information is not clearly visible or is placed in unexpected locations, users struggle to find what they need. In this case, users looked for age and weight information on the product page but were unable to find it, which caused confusion and slowed their decision-making process.

This breaks the natural flow of interaction and does not align with the usability principle “match between system and user expectations,” where information should be organized based on user expectations and common patterns (Nielsen, 1994).

Recommendation:

Including crucial information such as age range and weight capacity in the “details” section would make the decision-making process a lot more efficient for users. It would also increase the user’s confidence in purchasing the product and eliminate the need for the user to have to search for the information themselves. It is very important for this information to be as apparent as possible to ensure that the user is able to purchase the product without any doubts or confusions.

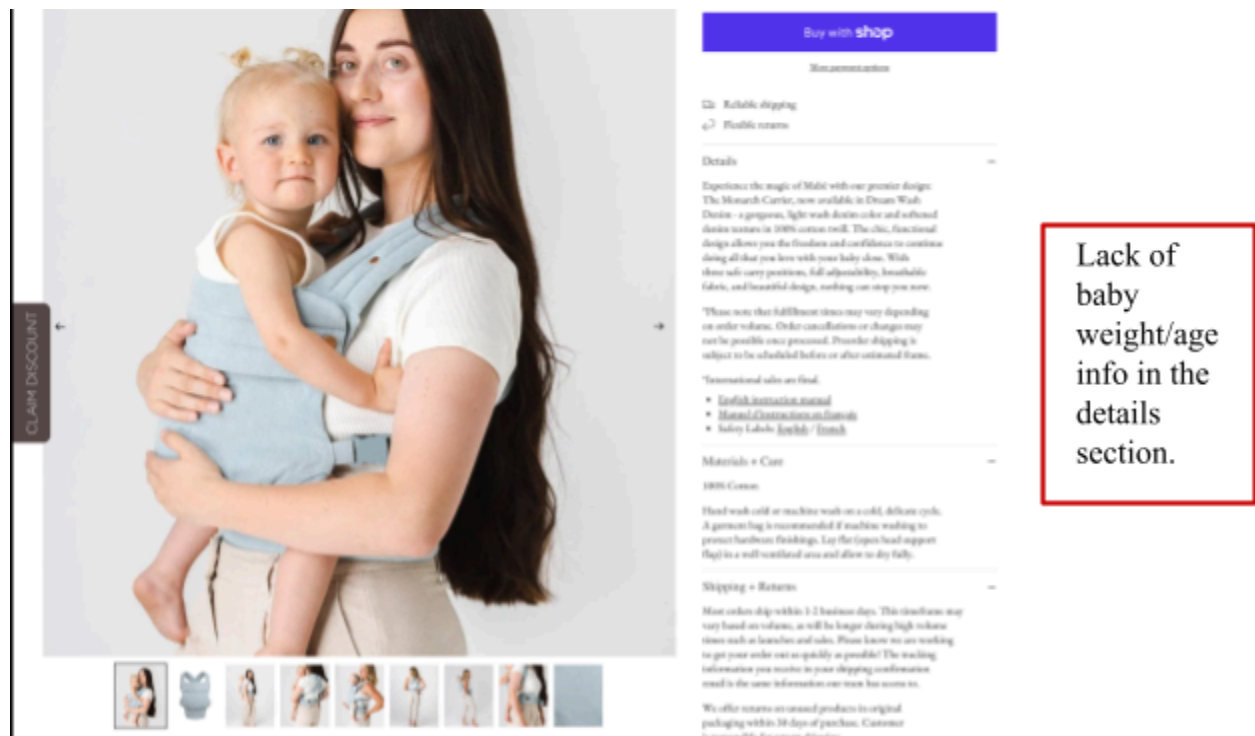


Figure 4: Screenshot showing proof of the lack of baby information in the “Details” section

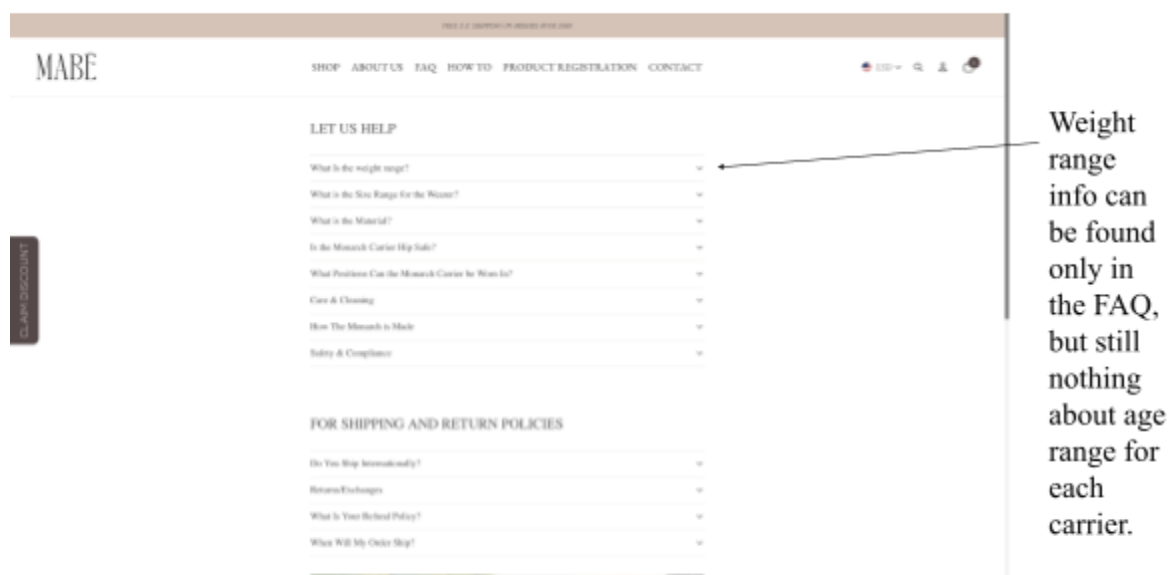


Figure 5: Screenshot of the FAQ page of mabeproducts.com

Conclusion

This usability study evaluated how effectively the mabeproducts.com website supports users in navigating, understanding, and making important decisions within an e-commerce environment. While this website's interface showcases a very modern design appealing to the current and upcoming generation of parents, the findings indicate various usability issues regarding information organization and decision-making support.

Across participants, consistent patterns emerged including difficulty reading the small font size, locating important information, and choosing colors. These issues contributed to confusion, hesitation, and an increased amount of time on each task.

Addressing these challenges through improving information presentation, font size, and reducing cognitive friction would greatly improve the user experience of this website and draw in more potential customers. Implementing the recommendations stated in this usability report will ultimately lead to a more efficient overall experience for users in the future.

References

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